MASTERFUNCTIONALSKILLS

★ OFQUAL REGULATED STANDARDS

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS ENGLISH

Level 1 Complete Suite

English Level 1 Revision Cards

Reading • Writing Layouts • SPaG • Speaking & Listening

- ★ Professional Email, Letter & Article Layouts
- ★ Purpose of Text (Inform, Persuade, Instruct)
- ★ Apostrophes, Commas & Core Spellings
- ★ Speaking, Listening & Communicating (SLC)

A6 Postcard Cardstock (148 × 105 mm)

Turn over for Deck Contents & Checklist ➔

📋 DECK CONTENTS & REVISION CHECKLIST

46 Revision Cards

Tick [✓] Read when you understand the rule, and [★] Solved when you answer the challenge!

Pearson & C&G Aligned

1. Main Points and Ideas (DfE L1.R1)
2. Text Types: Inform, Persuade, Instruct (DfE L1.R2)
3. Headings & Subheadings (DfE L1.R3)
4. Bullet Points & Lists (DfE L1.R4)
5. Images, Diagrams & Captions (DfE L1.R5)
6. Fact vs Opinion (Core Test) (DfE L1.R6)
7. Skimming for Overall Gist (DfE L1.R7)
8. Scanning for Facts & Numbers (DfE L1.R8)
9. Simple Inference (Reading Clues) (DfE L1.R9)
10. Vocabulary: Using Context Clues (DfE L1.R10)
11. Alphabetical Order & Directories (DfE L1.R11)
12. Instructions & Step-by-Step (DfE L1.R12)
13. Formal vs Informal Language (DfE L1.R13)
14. Comparing Two Simple Texts (DfE L1.R14)
15. Target Audience (Who is it for?) (DfE L1.R15)
16. Informal Email to a Friend (DfE L1.W16)
17. Formal Email (Enquiry/Absence) (DfE L1.W17)
18. Letter of Complaint (L1) (DfE L1.W18)
19. Community Newsletter Article (DfE L1.W19)
20. Writing an Event Flyer / Leaflet (DfE L1.W20)
21. Writing a Review (L1) (DfE L1.W21)
22. Incident & Accident Report (DfE L1.W22)
23. Basic Paragraphing (TiP ToP) (DfE L1.W23)
24. Using Linking Connectives (DfE L1.W24)
25. Writing Instructions (Bossy Verbs) (DfE L1.W25)
26. Varying Sentence Lengths (DfE L1.W26)
27. Tone: Polite and Constructive (DfE L1.W27)
28. Proofreading Checklist (DfE L1.W28)
29. Capital Letters: 5 Golden Rules (DfE L1.W29)
30. Full Stops & Question Marks (DfE L1.W30)
31. Exclamation Marks (!) (DfE L1.W31)
32. Commas in Lists (DfE L1.W32)
33. Apostrophes for Contractions (DfE L1.W33)
34. Apostrophes for Possession (DfE L1.W34)
35. Plural Spelling Rules (DfE L1.W35)
36. Irregular Plurals (DfE L1.W36)
37. Subject-Verb Agreement (L1) (DfE L1.W37)
38. Past Tense (-ed Rules) (DfE L1.W38)
39. Irregular Past Tense Verbs (DfE L1.W39)
40. Confusables: To / Too / Two (DfE L1.W40)
41. There / Their / They're (L1) (DfE L1.W41)
42. Essential Level 1 Spellings (DfE L1.W42)
43. SLC Overview: The Two Assessments (DfE L1.SLC1)
44. Asking Open & Follow-Up Questions (DfE L1.SLC2)
45. Turn-Taking & Collaborative Talk (DfE L1.SLC5)
46. Active Listening & Body Language (DfE L1.SLC7)

💡 **Tutor Golden Tip (Abdul):** Do not flip the card immediately! Attempt the Quick Challenge on the back using a dry-wipe pen or scratchpad first. Verify with the step-by-step model steps only after completing your working.

What is the Big Picture?

The main point is the most important message the author wants you to understand. Read the title, opening sentence, and closing sentence to identify the central message.

FINDING THE MAIN POINT

1. **Headline / Title: Gives the topic**
2. **First sentence: Introduces the central point**
3. **Ask yourself: "What is this text really telling me?"**

★ **Golden Rule: The main point is the overarching message, NOT a small illustrative detail!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't confuse an example with the main point.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R1

A text lists opening hours, emergency numbers, and ward rules for a hospital. What is the main point of the text?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

To inform visitors about essential hospital visiting rules and contact information.

Identify the Goal

Inform: Gives facts and data (news, timetables). Persuade: Wants you to buy or believe something (adverts, flyers). Instruct: Tells you how to do something step-by-step (recipes, user guides).

INFORM

Facts, statistics, dates, reports, and notices

PERSUADE

Adverts, reviews, speeches, and opinions

INSTRUCT

Numbered steps, recipes, bossy imperative verbs

★ **Golden Rule: Look for imperative verbs (Chop, Turn, Press) = INSTRUCT!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Adverts inform you about prices, but their PRIMARY goal is to PERSUADE you to buy.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DfE L1.R2

What type of text is a user manual for a washing machine?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

An instructional text (it gives step-by-step instructions on operating the appliance).

Signposts for Quick Navigation

Main Heading: Tells you what the whole document is about. Subheadings: Break the text into topics so you can quickly scan and find specific details without reading every single word.

MAIN TITLE: COMMUNITY CENTRE

Subheading 1: Opening Hours

Monday to Friday 9am - 8pm

Subheading 2: Room Hire Fees

Main Hall: £25 per hour

★ **Golden Rule: Read the subheadings first to find where your answer is hiding!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't read the whole article line-by-line if a subheading tells you exactly where the topic is.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R3

Under which subheading would you look to find out how much a fitness class costs?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Under 'Prices', 'Fees', or 'Cost'.

Clear, Distinct Items

Bullet points: Separate key items in a list so they stand out clearly. Numbered lists: Indicate a strict order of steps that must be done in sequence (1st, 2nd, 3rd).

BULLETS vs NUMBERING

- **Bullets: Order does not matter (checklist, packing list)**

1. **Numbered: Sequence MATTERS (recipe, safety fire drill)**

Makes information fast and easy to digest

★ **Golden Rule: Use numbered lists when steps MUST be followed in exact sequence!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Keep each bullet point short and grammatically consistent.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R4

Why are fire escape procedures presented as numbered lists rather than paragraphs?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

To ensure people follow the emergency steps in the correct chronological order without panic.

Visual Evidence & Explanations

Images and diagrams reinforce the written text. Captions are the short descriptive sentences directly below an image explaining what it shows.

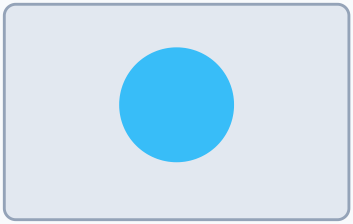


Figure 1: Solar panel installation

The Caption:

Explains the image and links to text

★ **Golden Rule: Always read the small print in the caption — it often contains exam answers!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't ignore the pictures — exam questions often ask how the graphic supports the article.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R5

What is the purpose of a caption underneath a photograph in a news article?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

To describe what is happening in the photograph and provide context for the reader.

True / False vs Personal Belief

Fact: Can be proven true with dates, measurements, or official records ('The shop opens at 8 am'). Opinion: What someone thinks or feels ('The shop is wonderful').

FACT (Proven)

"The library has 12 computers."

Can be counted & verified

OPINION (Feeling)

"It is the best place to study."

Personal point of view

★ **Golden Rule: If it uses words like 'best', 'delicious', or 'terrible', it is an OPINION!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Numbers and dates are almost always facts.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DfE L1.R6

Is this a fact or an opinion: 'The train ticket costs £14.50'?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

Fact (it is a verifiable price that can be proven true).

Rapid 30-Second Glance

Skimming is fast reading to get the general idea: 1. Read the title and subheadings. 2. Glance at the first and last sentence of each paragraph. 3. Look at any pictures. Do NOT read every word.

SKIMMING TECHNIQUE

✓ Read titles, subheadings & bold words

✓ Read the first sentence of each paragraph

Result: Understand the general topic in 30 seconds!

★ **Golden Rule: Skimming gives you the big picture without getting bogged down!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't read word-by-word when skimming — keep your eyes moving quickly down the page.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DfE L1.R7

What is the difference between skimming and scanning?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

Skimming is fast reading for the general overview; scanning is searching for a specific piece of information (like a number or name).

Search like a Metal Detector

Scanning is searching for specific targets: Look for capital letters (names, places), numbers (dates, times, prices), or symbols (£, %, @). Ignore everything else until you spot your target.

SCANNING TARGET CLUES

- **Looking for a price? Scan for: '£' and decimal points**
- **Looking for a person/place? Scan for: CAPITAL LETTERS**
- **Looking for a time? Scan for: 'am', 'pm', or colon (14:30)**

★ **Golden Rule: Lock your target in your mind before your eyes touch the page!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't start reading the whole text from the beginning when answering 'What time...' questions.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R8

If a question asks: 'Who is the event coordinator?', what visual clue will you scan for?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Scan for Capital Letters indicating a person's name or title (e.g. 'Coordinator' or 'Sarah Jenkins').

Detective Reading

Inference means working out meaning from hints in the text: If someone is wearing a heavy winter coat, gloves, and shivering, you infer that the weather is freezing.

INFERENCE DETECTIVE CLUES

Text: "She slammed her locker door and stomped away."

Inference: She is feeling very angry or upset.

★ **Golden Rule: Inference is finding the hidden clue in the writer's description!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Make sure your answer is directly supported by words in the text.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R9

Text: 'Liam yawned and kept rubbing his eyes during the lecture.' What can you infer about Liam?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

You can infer that Liam is tired or bored.

Guess the Word from the Sentence

If you don't know a word: 1. Read the words before and after it. 2. Look for examples or explanations in the sentence. 3. Try replacing it with a word you do know that makes sense.

CONTEXT CLUE STRATEGY

"The recipe requires several condiments, like ketchup and mustard."

Clue: Ketchup and mustard are sauces added to food.

Meaning: 'Condiments' means seasonings or sauces.

★ **Golden Rule: Read the whole sentence before deciding an unknown word is impossible!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't panic when you see long words — look for root words you already recognise.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R10

What does 'hazardous' mean in: 'Wear gloves when handling hazardous chemicals that burn the skin'?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'Hazardous' means dangerous or harmful.

Dictionaries & Index Pages

A to Z alphabetical order: Look at the 1st letter. If 1st letters are the same, look at the 2nd letter (Apple, Apricot). If 2nd letters match, look at the 3rd letter.

ALPHABETICAL ORDERING

Put in order: Brown, Baker, Bailey

1. All start with 'B'

2. Compare second letters: Ba... before Br...

3. Correct order: Bailey, Baker, Brown

★ **Golden Rule: Look at the 3rd and 4th letter if the first two letters are identical!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Surnames in directories are listed Last Name first: 'Smith, John'.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R11

Put in alphabetical order: Nurse, Needle, Next, Night.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Needle, Next, Night, Nurse.

Chronological Sequence & Imperatives

Instructions must be followed in order. Look for sequence words: First, Next, Then, After that, Finally. Action verbs (bossy verbs) start each instruction ('Turn off power').

FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: First, wash hands thoroughly

Step 2: Next, open sterile packaging

Step 3: Finally, apply bandage securely

★ **Golden Rule: Instructions always use imperative 'bossy' verbs at the start of sentences!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never skip a step when answering questions about instructional texts.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R12

Identify the imperative verb in: 'Carefully insert the key and turn clockwise.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'insert' and 'turn'.

Professional vs Casual Speech

Formal: Used with managers, council, doctors ('I am writing to enquire', no slang, full words). Informal: Used with friends, family ('Hi mate', contractions, emojis, casual phrases).

FORMAL

- "Dear Sir or Madam"
- "I am writing to..."
- "Yours sincerely"

INFORMAL

- "Hi Alex"
- "Can't wait to see you!"
- "Cheers / Bye"

★ **Golden Rule: Avoid contractions (don't, can't) when writing formal letters or reports!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't use informal slang like 'gonna' or 'cool' in workplace emails.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R13

Rewrite this informally for a friend: 'I should be delighted to accompany you to the cinema.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'I'd love to come to the cinema with you!' (or 'I'd love to go to the cinema!').

What is the Same? What is Different?

To compare two texts at Level 1: 1. State one piece of information that BOTH texts agree on. 2. State one difference between the two texts (e.g. price, opening time, or opinion).

LEVEL 1 TEXT COMPARISON

Agreement: "Both texts state the gym has a swimming pool."

Difference: "Text A costs £30, while Text B costs £35."

★ **Golden Rule: Always answer both parts: one similarity AND one difference!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Make sure you name both Text A and Text B in your answer.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R14

Text 1 says a cafe is open 7 days a week. Text 2 says it is open Monday to Saturday only. What is the difference?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Text 1 says the cafe opens on Sundays (7 days), while Text 2 says it is closed on Sundays (6 days).

Spotting Who the Text is Written For

To find the audience, look at who benefits from the information: Parents (school notices), Motorists (parking leaflet), Dog owners, Job seekers, Patients.

IDENTIFYING TARGET AUDIENCE

- Look at vocabulary and images
- Notice who is directly addressed ('Dear Residents')
- Be specific: 'New parents', not just 'people'

★ Golden Rule: Be specific when naming the audience (e.g. 'Gym members', NOT just 'adults')!

⚠️ Watch Out: Don't just say 'everyone' — almost every text has a specific intended reader.

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.R15

A leaflet gives advice on preparing babies for weaning onto solid food. Who is the target audience?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Parents and caregivers of young babies.

Friendly Greeting & Clear Points

Format: 1. Subject line. 2. Friendly greeting (Hi Sam / Dear Chloe). 3. Polite friendly opener ('Hope you are well'). 4. Clear details in 2 paragraphs. 5. Warm sign-off (Best wishes / See you soon).

Subject: Catching up / Weekend plans

Hi Marcus,

Hope you are having a good week. Would you like to meet...

See you soon, / Best wishes,

★ **Golden Rule: Always include a relevant Subject Line, even for friendly emails!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Even informal emails must have capital letters and full stops in exams.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DfE L1.W16

What are two appropriate sign-offs for an informal email to a friend?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

'Best wishes,' or 'See you soon,'.

Polite Workplace Message

Format: 1. Clear subject line ('Absence Notification - 12 Oct'). 2. Polite greeting (Dear Mr Davies). 3. Factual reason for email. 4. Request for confirmation or action. 5. Formal sign-off (Kind regards).

Subject: Absence Notification: [Your Name]

Dear Ms Taylor,

I am writing to inform you that I am unwell today and will be unable to attend work...

Kind regards,

★ **Golden Rule: Keep workplace emails concise, polite, and professional!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't write text-speak (e.g. 'u', 'thx', 'c u') in any exam email.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W17

Write a professional closing sign-off for a formal email to your tutor.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'Kind regards,' or 'Best regards,' followed by your full name.

Addresses • Clear Issue • Expected Remedy

Layout: Addresses and date at top. Opening: 'I am writing to complain about...'. Body: Factual details (date, receipt number, defect). Closing: What you want done ('I expect a full refund or replacement').

Dear Customer Services,

1. Reason: I am writing to complain about my recent order...

2. Problem: The item arrived damaged on 14th May...

3. Solution: I request a replacement or full refund...

Yours faithfully,

★ **Golden Rule: Be polite and factual — never use rude or abusive language when complaining!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Always state what resolution you expect (refund, apology, repair).**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DfE L1.W18

What should always be stated in the final paragraph of a complaint letter?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

The action or remedy you expect the company to take (e.g. a refund or replacement).

Catchy Title • Positive News • Details

Features: 1. Interesting Title. 2. Introduction: What, where, and when. 3. Body: Highlights, quotes, and benefits for residents. 4. Call to join or participate.

NEWSLETTER ARTICLE

Title: New Community Garden Opens!

On Saturday, local volunteers transformed the park...

Come along this Saturday at 10 am to help plant seeds!

★ **Golden Rule: Articles must have a headline at the top!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Organise into at least two or three paragraphs rather than one solid block of text.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W19

Write an engaging title for an article about a local fun run.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Example: 'Lace Up Your Trainers for the Annual Riverside Fun Run!'

Who • What • Where • When • Cost

A flyer must include the 5 W's: What the event is. When (date & time). Where (venue). Cost (ticket price / free). Who to contact (email / telephone / website).

COMMUNITY BAKE SALE

📅 **Date: Saturday 18th November | ⏰ Time: 10am - 2pm**

📍 **Venue: St Mark's Community Hall**

🎟️ **Entry: FREE (All proceeds to charity)**

📞 **Contact: bakesale@email.com / 01865 123456**

★ **Golden Rule: Make dates, times, and venue stand out with bullet points!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't forget contact details — visitors need to know how to book or ask questions.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DfE L1.W20

What five essential details must every event flyer include?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

1. Event name (what). 2. Date and time (when). 3. Location (where). 4. Price/ticket cost. 5. Contact information.

What You Liked & What Could Improve

Review structure: 1. Star rating (e.g. 4/5). 2. What you bought or experienced. 3. Positive features. 4. One thing that could be improved. 5. Overall recommendation.

CAFE REVIEW ★★★★★

✓ Positives: Delicious food and friendly staff.

✕ Drawback: The service was slightly slow at lunch.

Recommendation: I would definitely return!

⋆ Golden Rule: Give specific reasons for your opinion rather than just saying 'it was good'!

⚠ Watch Out: Mention both pros and at least one small con to show balanced judgment.

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W21

Write a sentence recommending a book or film you enjoyed.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'I would highly recommend this film because the storyline was exciting and kept me guessing until the very end.'

Strictly Factual & Clear

Workplace report format: 1. Date, time, and location of incident. 2. Persons involved and witnesses. 3. Factual description of what occurred (no guessing). 4. First aid given or action taken.

ACCIDENT REPORT FORM

Date: 12 October | Time: 14:15 | Location: Warehouse Bay 3

Details: Employee slipped on spilled water near the sink.

Action Taken: First aid ice pack applied; area cordoned off.

Reported by: [Staff Name]

★ **Golden Rule: Incident reports must be 100% factual — state only what happened!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't assign blame or write emotional rants in an incident report.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DfE L1.W22

Why should personal opinions be excluded from an workplace accident report?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

Accident reports must be objective legal records based entirely on verified facts.

New Idea = New Paragraph

Start a new paragraph whenever there is a change in: Time (later that day), Place (back at the office), Topic (turning to the cost), or Person (a new speaker). Leave a blank line between paragraphs.

WHEN TO START A NEW PARAGRAPH

Ti - Time (Next morning, Later)

P - Place (In the hospital, At home)

To - Topic (Discussing the cost, Looking at safety)

P - Person (A different speaker or character)

★ **Golden Rule: Leave a clear blank line between paragraphs in your exam!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: One giant unspaced block of writing loses marks for organisation.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DfE L1.W23

What does the 'TiP ToP' paragraph rule stand for?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

Ti = Time, P = Place, To = Topic, P = Person (start a new paragraph when any of these change).

Joining Sentences Smoothly

Use connectives to connect ideas: Adding (and, also, as well as). Contrasting (but, however, although). Explaining cause (because, so, therefore). Sequencing (then, after that, finally).

ESSENTIAL CONNECTIVES

Cause: "I was late BECAUSE the bus broke down."

Contrast: "The car was old, HOWEVER it ran well."

Addition: "We need bread AND we also need milk."

★ **Golden Rule: Linking words turn short choppy sentences into flowing prose!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't start every sentence with 'And' or 'Because'.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W24

Join these two sentences with a suitable connective: 'It was raining heavily. We decided to walk to work.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'Although it was raining heavily, we decided to walk to work' (or 'It was raining heavily, but we decided to walk to work').

Start with Imperative Verbs

When writing instructions, start each point with a clear command verb (imperative): 'Chop', 'Wash', 'Turn', 'Press', 'Check'. Keep sentences direct, short, and numbered.

IMPERATIVE COMMAND VERBS

1. Wash hands with warm soap and water.
2. Remove the plastic safety cap.
3. Press the red button to power on.

★ **Golden Rule: Put the action verb first: 'Press button', not 'You should press button'!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Avoid polite padding like 'If you wouldn't mind pressing...' in user instructions.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W25

Rewrite as a clear command instruction: 'You need to make sure the door is locked before leaving.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'Lock the door securely before leaving.'

Mix Short and Long Sentences

Use a mix: Short sentences create impact, suspense, or clarity ('Stop immediately.'). Longer compound sentences explain reasons and add detail smoothly.

SENTENCE VARIETY

Short: "Help arrived just in time." (Impact)

Long: "The team worked together through the night, and they successfully restored full electrical power."

★ **Golden Rule: A short sentence at the end of a paragraph creates drama and punch!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't write endless rambling sentences joined by 'and... and... and...'.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W26

Why should you avoid having all sentences the same length?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Writing with varied sentence lengths sounds natural, engaging, and prevents the text from becoming repetitive.

Professional Courtesy

Always maintain a polite, respectful tone even when making a complaint: Use 'Please could you look into this matter' rather than 'You need to sort this out now'.

CONSTRUCTIVE POLITE TONE

Rude: "Your staff are useless and I want my money back."

Polite: "I was disappointed with the service received, and would appreciate a full refund at your convenience."

★ **Golden Rule: Polite firmness achieves faster results than angry hostility!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never write in ALL CAPITALS in an email — it looks like shouting.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DfE L1.W27

Make this sentence more polite: 'Give me the report by 3 pm.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

'Please could you provide the report by 3 pm?'

Final 3-Minute Sweep

Before submitting: 1. Capitals on names and 'I'. 2. Full stop at every sentence end. 3. Correct homophones (there/their/they're). 4. Clear paragraphs. 5. Does every sentence make sense?

5-POINT PROOFREADING SWEEP

[✓] 1. Every sentence starts with a CAPITAL letter

[✓] 2. Every sentence ends with . or ?

[✓] 3. The pronoun 'I' is always capitalized

[✓] 4. Clear paragraph breaks

★ **Golden Rule: Read your work slowly in your head to check for missing words!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't rush to finish early — use the last minutes to collect easy SPaG marks.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DfE L1.W28

What punctuation mark is missing from: 'How much does a weekly train ticket cost'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

A question mark (? at the end of the sentence).

M.I.N.T.S Rules

Always use a capital letter for: M - Months & Days (Monday, July). I - The word 'I'. N - Names of people & places (Sarah, London). T - Titles of books/films. S - Start of every sentence.

M.I.N.T.S FOR CAPITAL LETTERS

M - Months & Days: Friday, October

I - The pronoun: 'I' (NEVER lower case 'i')

N - Names: David, Manchester, NHS

S - Start of every new sentence

★ **Golden Rule: The word 'I' is ALWAYS a capital letter, no matter where it is in a sentence!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Days and months must have capitals: 'wednesday' and 'august' are WRONG.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W29

Correct the capital letters: 'last monday, i went to birmingham with my sister anna.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'Last Monday, I went to Birmingham with my sister Anna.'

Sentence Endings

Every complete sentence must end with an end mark: Full stop (.) for statements. Question mark (?) for direct questions starting with Who, What, Where, When, Why, How, or Can.

SENTENCE ENDINGS

Statement (.): "The meeting begins at 10 am."

Question (?): "What time does the meeting start?"

★ **Golden Rule: Direct questions always demand a question mark (?)!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never use multiple question marks (???) or full stops (...!) in exam writing.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W30

Add the correct punctuation mark: 'Could you please confirm your email address'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'Could you please confirm your email address?'

Urgency, Surprise & Warning

Use exclamation marks (!) sparingly to show strong emotion, surprise, danger, or urgency ('Watch out!', 'What wonderful news!'). Avoid in formal letters and reports.

EXCLAMATION MARK RULES

✓ Use for emergency warnings: 'Fire! Evacuate now!'

✓ Use in friendly flyers: 'Join our summer gala!'

✕ DO NOT use in formal reports or complaint letters!

★ Golden Rule: One exclamation mark is enough — never write '!!' or '!!!'!

⚠ Watch Out: Overusing exclamation marks makes writing look childish.

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W31

Is an exclamation mark appropriate in a formal letter to your local council about council tax?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

No, formal letters should maintain a calm, professional tone using full stops.

Separating 3 or More Items

Use commas to separate items in a list of three or more things. Do NOT put a comma before the word 'and' at the end of a simple list.

COMMA LIST RULE

"We bought milk, eggs, bread and butter."

Commas between first items; 'and' before the last item.

★ **Golden Rule: Comma between items, 'and' before the final item!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't put a comma after the final item in the list.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DfE L1.W32

Punctuate with commas: 'The stall sold cakes pies pastries and fresh bread.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

'The stall sold cakes, pies, pastries and fresh bread.'

Replacing Missing Letters

An apostrophe replaces missing letters when two words are joined into one: do not → don't (o is missing). cannot → can't (no is missing). it is → it's (i is missing).

CONTRACTION APOSTROPHES

do not → don't (replaces 'o')

could not → couldn't (replaces 'o')

they have → they've (replaces 'ha')

★ **Golden Rule: The apostrophe sits exactly where the missing letter used to be!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't write 'dont' or 'cant' without an apostrophe — examiners mark these as spelling errors.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W33

Write the contracted form with an apostrophe for: 'have not'.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'haven't'.

Showing Who Owns What

Singular owner: Add 's after the owner's name (the boy's bike = bike belongs to one boy). Plural owners: If word already ends in s, just add apostrophe after the s (the boys' bikes = bikes belong to many boys).

POSSESSIVE APOSTROPHE

Singular: John's bag (1 person owns it)

Plural: The teachers' lounge (many teachers)

⚠️ **Never use an apostrophe for simple plurals ('two cats')!**

★ **Golden Rule: Ask: 'Who does it belong to?' Then put the apostrophe after the owner!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: 'CDs' and '1990s' do NOT have apostrophes (they are simple plurals).**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W34

Add the possessive apostrophe: 'The nurse coat was hanging on the door.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'The nurse's coat was hanging on the door.'

-s, -es, -ies, -ves

Standard: Add -s (book → books). Ending in ch, sh, s, x: Add -es (box → boxes, watch → watches). Ending in consonant + y: Drop y, add -ies (baby → babies). Ending in f/fe: Change to -ves (leaf → leaves).

PLURAL SPELLING RULES

box → boxes (ends in x, s, ch, sh → add -es)

city → cities (consonant + y → change to -ies)

knife → knives (ends in f/fe → change to -ves)

★ Golden Rule: If there's a vowel before 'y' (boy, day), just add 's' (boys, days)!

⚠️ Watch Out: Don't write 'babys' or 'boxs' — apply the rules.

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DfE L1.W35

What is the correct plural form of 'match'?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

'matches' (ends in 'ch', so add '-es').

Words That Change Internally

Some words change their internal vowels instead of adding 's': man → men, woman → women, child → children, person → people, tooth → teeth, foot → feet, mouse → mice. Sheep and fish stay the same.

IRREGULAR PLURALS

child → children (NOT childs)

person → people (NOT persons)

tooth → teeth • foot → feet

★ **Golden Rule: Never add an 's' to irregular plurals: 'childrens' is WRONG!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: 'Women' is pronounced 'wim-in' (plural); 'woman' is singular.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DfE L1.W36

Correct the error: 'Several childs were playing in the park.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

'Several children were playing in the park.'

Singular vs Plural Matching

I go / He goes. We are / She is. They were / He was. You do / She does. The verb must agree with who is doing the action.

AGREEMENT MATCHING

He WAS (singular) | They WERE (plural)

She DOES (singular) | They DO (plural)

✕ "We was going..." → ✓ "We were going..."

★ **Golden Rule: 'We was' is always marked wrong — it must be 'We were'!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Watch out for slang habits in speaking that creep into written work.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W37

Choose the correct verb: 'The nurses (was / were) very supportive.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'were' ('nurses' is plural, so it takes 'were').

Regular Past Tense Suffixes

Most regular verbs add -ed (walk → walked). If verb ends in 'e', just add 'd' (like → liked). If short vowel + consonant, double consonant (stop → stopped, plan → planned).

REGULAR PAST TENSE (-ED)

walk + ed = walked

hope + d = hoped (drop redundant e)

stop → stopped (double the 'p')

★ Golden Rule: Double the consonant if the vowel before it is short (hop → hopped)!

⚠️ Watch Out: 'Hoped' (from hope) has one 'p'; 'hopped' (from hop) has two 'p's.

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W38

Write the past tense of the verb 'drop'.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'dropped' (double the final consonant).

Saw • Went • Bought • Came

Irregular verbs do NOT add -ed in the past tense: See → saw (NOT seened or sawed). Go → went (NOT goed). Buy → bought (NOT buyed). Come → came (NOT comed). Write → wrote.

IRREGULAR VERBS IN PAST TENSE

see → SAW | go → WENT

buy → BOUGHT | catch → CAUGHT

⚠️ "I seen it" is WRONG → "I SAW it"

★ Golden Rule: 'I saw it' is correct; 'I seen it' is incorrect without 'have'!

⚠️ Watch Out: Don't add -ed to words that already changed: 'went', not 'wented'.

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.W39

Correct the past tense verb: 'Yesterday, she goed to the supermarket and buyed milk.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'Yesterday, she went to the supermarket and bought milk.'

Direction • Also/Excessive • Number

TO: Direction or verb ('Going to school', 'to sleep'). TOO: Means 'also' or 'too much' ('Can I come too?', 'too hot'). TWO: The number 2 ('two tickets').

TO

Direction / Action

"Go to work"

TOO

Also / Excessive

"Too expensive"

TWO

Number 2

"Two cups"

★ **Golden Rule: 'Too' has an extra 'o' because it has too much of something!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: 'I want to go to' is WRONG — it must be 'I want to go too'.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DfE L1.W40

Fill the blanks: 'We bought (to / too / two) tickets (to / too / two) London.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

'We bought two tickets to London.'

Location • Belonging • They Are

THERE has 'here' in it = place ('over there'). THEIR has 'heir' in it = ownership ('their coats'). THEY'RE has an apostrophe = 'they are' ('they're coming').

HOMOPHONE MEMORY TRICK

tHERE = Has the word 'HERE' (place)

tHEIR = Belongs to them

THEY'RE = Short for 'THEY ARE'

★ **Golden Rule: Test with 'they are' — if it fits, use 'they're'!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: This is tested in almost every Functional Skills English exam.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DfE L1.W41

Which word completes the sentence: 'The team forgot to submit _____ timesheets.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

'their' (possession/belonging to the team).

The 10 Golden Words

1. Because (Big Elephants Can Always Upset Small Elephants). 2. Beautiful. 3. Believe (never be-LIE-ve a lie). 4. Friend (ends in end). 5. Tomorrow (1 'm', 2 'r's). 6. Wednesday. 7. People.

ESSENTIAL SPELLING MNEMONICS

- **FriEND: A true friend stays to the END**
- **Wed-nes-day: Say it as 'Wed-Nes-Day'**
- **Tomorrow: 1 Morning, 2 Roses (1 m, 2 r's)**

★ **Golden Rule: Spell 'friend' with 'i' before 'e', ending in 'end'!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: 'Becos' and 'tommorow' are immediate red pen errors.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DfE L1.W42

Spell the day of the week that comes after Tuesday.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

'Wednesday'.

Task 1: Short Talk (4-5m) | Task 2: Group Discussion

Level 1 SLC consists of two parts: (1) A 4–5 minute formal talk or explanation on a prepared topic followed by questions, and (2) A 10–15 minute group discussion on an everyday topic.

TASK 1: FORMAL TALK

- 4–5 mins prepared talk
- Clear Intro, 3 Points, End
- Answer audience Q&A

TASK 2: DISCUSSION

- 10–15 mins (3–5 peers)
- Share views & listen
- Take turns & invite others

★ **Golden Rule: Use bullet-point cue cards — never read a full script word-for-word!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Reading aloud head-down from an A4 essay script prevents eye contact and caps your grade.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.SLC1

What are the two mandatory tasks in the Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Speaking, Listening & Communicating assessment?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Task 1: Formal 4–5 minute Talk/Presentation + Q&A. Task 2: Informal 10–15 minute Group Discussion (3–5 learners).

Open Questions (How/Why) vs Closed (Yes/No)

Closed questions (Do you...? Is it...?) get one-word Yes/No answers that stall discussions. Open questions (How would...? Why do you think...?) invite detailed opinions and examples.

✕ CLOSED (STALLS TALK)

"Do you agree with this?"

Reply: "Yes." (Silence)

✓ OPEN (SPARKS DEBATE)

"How would this change impact local commuters?"

Invites full explanation!

★ **Golden Rule: Use HOW, WHY, or WHAT to ask open questions and invite full answers!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Ask at least two relevant questions to meet the passing criteria.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DfE L1.SLC2

Turn this closed question into an open question: "Do you think flexible working hours are a good idea?"

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Open question: "How do you think flexible working hours would affect staff morale?" (requires a detailed explanation, not just yes/no).

Acknowledge • Build • Invite (A-B-I)

Assessors grade how well you take turns: (1) Acknowledge ("Building on Ana's point..."), (2) Add your evidence, and (3) Invite quieter members ("What is your view on this, David?").

TURN-TAKING STEMS FOR FULL MARKS

1. **Agree & Build:** "Following on from what Sarah said..."
2. **Polite Challenge:** "I see your point, but another angle is..."
3. **Invite Others:** "We haven't heard from Leo yet—what do you think?"

★ **Golden Rule: Acknowledge the last speaker before introducing your own point!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never interrupt or dominate — invite quieter group members to speak.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DfE L1.SLC5

Give a polite, collaborative phrase to disagree with a colleague named Sam about budget costs.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

"I understand your point about the cost, Sam; however, have we considered how much energy the new lighting will save over five years?"

Eye Contact • Posture • Measured Pace

Non-verbal communication carries half your impact: maintain steady eye contact across the room, nod to show active listening, speak at a measured pace, and avoid slang in formal talks.

NON-VERBAL SIGNALS

- ✓ Eye contact with all
- ✓ Nodding when listening
- ✓ Open hand gestures

VOCAL DELIVERY

- ✓ Clear, steady pace
- ✓ Varied pitch & emphasis
- ✓ Professional register

★ **Golden Rule: Match your tone and body language to the formality of the setting!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Crossing your arms, looking at your phone, or staring only at the assessor loses engagement marks.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DfE L1.SLC7

State two non-verbal body language signals that show assessors you are actively listening.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

Maintain regular eye contact with the group, nod to show active listening, and keep an open, upright posture.